

## Chapter 49-1

Xu Qingzhu's words were very difficult not to misinterpret.

The room was an enclosed space where light and shadow intertwined. Liang Shi lay on the bed feeling the softness of the expensive mattress.

Heat radiated from her body, making her feel like a cooked crab.

There was nowhere left to retreat.

Her legs felt tingly and weak.

Where Xu Qingzhu was pressing against her, her knees had already bent. The sound of fabric rustling in the quiet room accompanied slightly rapid breathing, her heartbeat accelerating to an unbearable pace.

She felt like she might explode at any moment.

Liang Shi gently bit her lip, not daring to speak anymore.

But Xu Qingzhu pressed closer step by step, her other hand gently caressing Liang Shi's palm. Her soft fingertips traced and lingered, as if drawing a picture in her palm.

But Liang Shi had no ability to judge what it was. Her palm felt extremely itchy, and she wanted to curl her fingers back several times, but was blocked by Xu Qingzhu's fingers each time.

Liang Shi's fingers kept curling, her breathing becoming rapid.

In this atmosphere, the glands at the back of her neck began to stir restlessly, releasing Alpha-specific pheromones.

And she also caught the scent of strawberry Baileys.

Sweet, rich, fragrant.

Making one want to become intoxicated in it.

The pheromone scents merged in the air, not as intense as during heat periods.

Light, subtle.

Yet more alluring than rich pheromones, more capable of stirring emotions.

Xu Qingzhu's pheromones would make one drunk if inhaled too much, yet made one unable to resist wanting more.

It was the scent of a liqueur that Liang Shi particularly liked.

Liang Shi briefly held her breath, the heart in her chest about to leap out.

Then Xu Qingzhu suddenly smiled seductively, her clear eyes taking on an indescribable meaning, "Liang Shi, is it that you haven't learned how to mark?"

Liang Shi: "..."

When people stand on the edge of desire, they often speak without thinking.

Liang Shi was in grave danger.

But that call of "Liang Shi" pulled her back somewhat from the edge of desire. She closed her eyes, her voice weak, "I know how."

A moment later, she opened her eyes. Those eyes now intertwined desire with wickedness as her hand suddenly gripped Xu Qingzhu's hand that had been carelessly caressing her palm. Their hands overlapped, one cold, one hot.

Though Liang Shi lowered her voice, it carried a dangerous undertone, "Do you really want me to mark you?"

In an instant, she turned from defense to offense.

Xu Qingzhu frowned slightly, a flash of uncertainty in her eyes, but she still smiled and said, "Didn't you say you couldn't?"

The other's aura was too overwhelming, and Liang Shi almost couldn't handle it.

But years of acting training were enough to let Liang Shi respond without changing expression. She gritted her teeth, "If you want it, I could reluctantly manage."

Xu Qingzhu stared straight at her.

After a while, she suddenly laughed softly, her soft body leaning to the left side, falling directly onto the bed, right on Liang Shi's uninjured side.

Xu Qingzhu's long hair scattered across Liang Shi's arm.

Only then did that intensely oppressive atmosphere disappear, leaving only the faint strawberry wine fragrance lingering in the air.

## Chapter 49-2

After a long while, Liang Shi let out a heavy breath.

Xu Qingzhu laughed softly, the sound continuing for quite some time.

After she finished laughing, she said, "Liang Shi, you're really interesting."

Liang Shi helplessly closed her eyes.

How could she not understand Xu Qingzhu's intentions?

Still testing her.

Seizing any opportunity to probe.

Coming at her at every chance, seemingly giving up, but then making a comeback when she wasn't paying attention.

If she hadn't caught that flash of cunning in her eyes, Liang Shi might have really fallen into her trap.

But this time she had truly misunderstood Xu Qingzhu.

Xu Qingzhu had merely found her reaction amusing and wanted to tease her a bit. Only that last question could barely be considered probing.

But it wasn't forceful.

In reality, Xu Qingzhu had simply wanted to help treat the wound on her shoulder.

After this ordeal, Liang Shi felt they couldn't continue like this.

Once she recovered, she couldn't help but say to Xu Qingzhu, "Could you please not test me in this way anymore?"

The two lay on the bed, though not skin to skin, they maintained a very close distance.

Close enough that a slight turn would bring them into an embrace.

Xu Qingzhu looked at her and raised an eyebrow, "Which way?"

Her cool voice carried no desire as she spoke, yet Liang Shi somehow heard seductive undertones.

Probably because she had been bewitched by her earlier demeanor and voice.

Whenever they were close, she couldn't help but let her imagination run wild.

Liang Shi sighed, "Just... that..."

She paused before saying seriously, "Seduction."

The curve of Xu Qingzhu's lips never straightened, full of amusement as she said, "Didn't you say you couldn't? So what difference does it make whether I seduce you or not?"

Liang Shi: "..."

She sat up and looked at Xu Qingzhu very seriously.

Xu Qingzhu was indeed beautiful, whether in appearance, figure, or through their recent interactions - she was very attractive.

Even if she were a stranger, approaching in that manner just now, it would be difficult for anyone to say they could definitely maintain self-control.

Liang Shi pursed her lips, rendered speechless by her words.

She certainly wasn't incapable.

In fact, she had learned how to mark, though she hadn't practiced it yet.

But Xu Qingzhu had a legitimate Alpha. What she needed to do now was complete her mission, get her own body back, divorce Xu Qingzhu, and let Xu Qingzhu worry-free establish her own business empire, meet her proper Alpha Lu Jiayi, and become a winner in life.

While she had her own things to do.

So she couldn't possibly have any relationship with Xu Qingzhu.

Even if it meant choosing the most humiliating option - admitting she was incapable.

For Liang Shi, if there was a shortcut on the road to success, and this shortcut didn't harm others, she would naturally choose the shortcut.

Her desperate words when she first transmigrated obviously belonged to such a shortcut.

It straightforwardly indicated that she wouldn't mark Xu Qingzhu.

But Xu Qingzhu's repeated testing made her walk on the edge of desire multiple times.

One careless step and she'd fall into the abyss.

Moreover, Xu Qingzhu hadn't realized the seriousness of this problem.

Should she say that the current Xu Qingzhu was too carefree, or that she trusted herself too much?

Once an Alpha wanted to mark her, how could an Omega possibly resist?

Liang Shi felt it was necessary to have a talk with her.

While trying not to hurt their relationship.

"What if I really wanted to mark you?" Liang Shi expressed herself euphemistically, but used a very serious and solemn tone, restraining all gentleness. "Would you let me mark you?"

Once the question was asked, the temperature in the room dropped considerably.

Xu Qingzhu restrained her smile and looked at her calmly.

One sitting, one lying, yet neither was at a disadvantage.

Even though Liang Shi was a little angry, she could still control her temper well.

She showed none of it.

"What do you think?" Xu Qingzhu threw the question back to her.

Liang Shi didn't continue "playing hot potato" with her and answered seriously, "You wouldn't."

Xu Qingzhu stared straight at her, those clear eyes like flowing lake water.

"You don't completely trust me," Liang Shi said. "You couldn't possibly entrust your future to me. What are you trying to test now? What do you want to know?"

Liang Shi easily pierced through the ambiguous atmosphere floating between them. "Whether I'm Liang Shi or not, you wouldn't let me mark you. I hurt you so deeply before - you couldn't possibly forget. Even if I knelt down to beg your forgiveness, even if I carved out my heart to show you, you still wouldn't trust me again."

Xu Qingzhu slowly tensed her spine.

Her eyes became guarded, containing a barely perceptible sharpness.

"And if I'm not Liang Shi, how could you trust someone you've only known for a short time? Even though we've shared the same bed, even though I've told you everything about myself, that's not enough for you to entrust your future to me." Liang Shi exhaled lightly. "Isn't this the answer you wanted to know? I'm telling you."

Xu Qingzhu sat up, her expression not quite right.

She frowned, seeming to realize that this joke had gone too far.

It had just been a momentary impulse - she didn't know why Liang Shi would react so strongly.

She had simply found her expression amusing and wanted to tease her a bit.

The excuse Liang Shi had given was really too clumsy.

"I am Liang Shi," Liang Shi said. "But I'm also not Liang Shi."

"You don't need to test me anymore. You just need to know that I won't hurt you." Liang Shi looked at her. "In fact, I hope for your wellbeing more than anyone else."

Only when the target of her mission was well would she be well too.

Liang Shi's expression and appeal were simple.

She didn't know if Xu Qingzhu understood what she meant, but she really didn't want Xu Qingzhu to test her in this way anymore.

"As an Omega, haven't you thought about the possible consequences of doing this?" Liang Shi looked at her calmly. "If I really were like before, forcibly marking you, what would you do? Could you resist?"

Xu Qingzhu lowered her eyes.

The air in the room seemed to freeze, and for a moment neither of them spoke.

## Chapter 49-3

After a long while, Xu Qingzhu reached into her pocket and took out something the size of a fingernail - rectangular, about three millimeters thick. She lightly pressed the end, and a sharp blade popped out, gleaming dangerously in the light's refraction.

It was a tool similar to a utility knife, but thinner, smaller, and sharper.

"..."

A few seconds later, Liang Shi asked, "Aren't you afraid of accidentally pressing it and cutting yourself?"

Xu Qingzhu: "It's fingerprint-activated."

Only by pressing that button with her own fingerprint would the blade emerge.

And if she were in a passive position, she could silently injure her opponent from behind.

After the incident at Huayue International last time, she had someone custom-make this tool for her.

"..."

"Even if you can protect yourself, is it okay for you to do this?" Liang Shi asked again. "Do you use this method with everyone you want to test?"

"Of course not." Xu Qingzhu firmly denied. "I'm not crazy."

"Then why with me, do you..." Liang Shi stopped mid-sentence and said helplessly, "Never mind."

"Finish what you were saying," Xu Qingzhu said.

Liang Shi shook her head on her own, "Anyway, don't do this anymore in the future."

If there was a next time, she wasn't sure she could maintain her self-control.

Being a gentleman was difficult.

What annoyed her most was that feeling of being toyed with.

Knowing clearly that Xu Qingzhu wouldn't fall for her, wouldn't let her mark her, yet she could still feel her heart racing from it, would have that moment of thinking: mark her, fall in love with her.

It wasn't like she hadn't acted in romantic scenes before.

She had never experienced such feelings.

These overly complex emotions were beyond her current control. For someone who only wanted to survive right now, she didn't want to think about such matters.

Especially when the other person definitely wouldn't like her.

"I'm sorry." Xu Qingzhu also understood she had gone too far. She distanced herself from Liang Shi. "I didn't control the degree of my joking well."

Liang Shi pressed her temples.

After a long while, Liang Shi said gently, "Don't use yourself as a bargaining chip for testing. Even if you carry self-protection tools, there's still a one percent chance of accidents. You can't afford to gamble."

Xu Qingzhu was stunned, "But because it's you, I dared to gamble."

Liang Shi's attitude was sincere, every sentence considering her wellbeing.

Xu Qingzhu didn't hide anything either. She said very honestly, "I believe eyes don't lie. And you won't hurt me."

In other words, because Liang Shi had given her confidence and the right to take the initiative.

So she dared to press closer step by step, dared to risk herself.

That's how it had been before.

But tonight was just a simple joke.

Unknowingly, she had gone too far.

Xu Qingzhu also felt annoyed about this. She exhaled lightly and apologized again, "Sorry, it won't happen again."



## Chapter 49-4

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After such a scene, the atmosphere was indeed awkward.

For a moment, neither of them spoke.

After getting angry, Liang Shi reflected on whether she had spoken too harshly, even beginning to feel grateful that the bad luck system wasn't working now, otherwise her bad luck points tonight would have maxed out.

And Xu Qingzhu reflected on why she had acted that way.

It was too bizarre.

Even if she had categorized Liang Shi as one of "her own people," it wasn't to the extent where she could do such things.

Besides, she wasn't improper with all of "her own people."

It depended on the person.

Occasionally she would indeed make some improper jokes with Sally.

Or insert a few comments when Sally and Cherry made outrageous jokes.

However, after reflecting for a while, Xu Qingzhu finally remembered what her original purpose had been.

It was that Liang Shi's shoulder was bleeding!

Xu Qingzhu helplessly supported her forehead, but didn't ask Liang Shi to come over again. She just said, "Don't you need to treat the wound on your shoulder?"

Liang Shi: "..."

She turned to look, and indeed there was blood seeping through the bandage. It should have been caused by using too much force when entering the room earlier.

Xu Qingzhu asked, "Do you have new bandages?"

After asking, she fell silent again.

Even if there were, could she be the one to change them?

She didn't know how either.

Liang Shi also timely helped her out of the awkward situation, "There's a family doctor. I'll go downstairs to find her."

Liang Shi gripped the door handle and opened it, "You should wash up and rest early."

Though her tone hadn't changed much, everyone could detect that her mood had become somewhat cold.

After she left, Xu Qingzhu lay back on the bed and covered her face with her hands.

Really.

What was she doing?

If time could turn back, she definitely wouldn't have done that.

But a few seconds later, she suddenly realized - had Liang Shi admitted it?

Both was and wasn't.

Both was Liang Shi, but not the original Liang Shi.

Xu Qingzhu thought for a moment and still felt this was like a philosophical problem.

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Liang Shi went downstairs to find the doctor to change her bandage, which ended quickly.

After finishing, she didn't want to return to the room, so she curled up on the downstairs sofa, casually opening a management game to play while actually spacing out in a daze.

Only after calming her emotions did she get up, but when she reached the second-floor staircase, she faintly heard Qiu Zimin's voice coming from upstairs.

Curiosity drove her up a few steps.

Her footsteps were very light as she leaned against the railing, finally able to hear what Qiu Zimin was saying.

"I've already changed her room." Qiu Zimin lowered her voice as she spoke, her tone carrying some displeasure. "She was clearly already tamed, but then changed shortly after getting married. Master, do you think there's something wrong with this marriage?"

"I think there is a problem. That Xu Qingzhu isn't a good person either. Recently they've both been at the old mansion - surely they can do something about it."

"Actually, it's fine not to do anything, but I just can't swallow this anger. That little thing Liang Shi - after all I've given her over the years, she still doesn't know contentment? Most importantly, she's neither crazy nor stupid, when she was so close before."

"Not sending her to a mental hospital is my regret, but soon she'll become a homeless dog. Without the Liang family as backing, let's see how far she can jump."

"I'm not arguing with a little girl - what kind of little girl is she? She's trash."

"Anyway, just do as I told you when talking to my husband. He'll believe you. After this succeeds, your benefits won't be small. By the way, I'll be going up Yunfeng Mountain this Sunday - will you be there?"

"Even if this thing doesn't work on her, it can still drive her crazy. Besides, if you say it works, then it works. Even if it doesn't work, it has to work."

"..."

Qiu Zimin's words were like ice picks, stabbing into Liang Shi's heart one by one.

Even though she already knew she wasn't a good person, hearing these words still felt like a basin of cold water poured from overhead.

Bone-chillingly cold.

Liang Shi didn't want to alert her, but it seemed this Sunday that Taoist Master Yunyin would be at Yunfeng Mountain.

She could go then.

But just as she took a step up the stairs, Qiu Zimin's voice suddenly rang out, "Not sleeping so late - here to eavesdrop?"

Liang Shi's footsteps stopped.

She turned around to see Qiu Zimin standing there looking down at her, frowning slightly, "What did you hear?"

"I'm not your daughter, am I?" Liang Shi suddenly asked her back.

Qiu Zimin's brows furrowed, "What nonsense are you talking?"

Liang Shi then smiled, "If it were your daughter being treated this way, would you feel sad?"